IP 13: Advances in Statistics and Informatics in Agriculture

IP 13.1.IVRI-Pashu Prajanan App: A Tool for Knowledge Dissemination on Animal Reproduction

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Livestock production plays a major role in the upliftment of farmer's livelihood. A number of technologies have been developed for preventing livestock diseases and improving production, however, many of these technologies have not been fully implemented in the Indian livestock sector resulting to heavy losses to the farmers. One of the major reasons being the lack of proper and timely information delivery to the livestock owners. NSSO report indicates that only 5.1 percent of the households access information on animal husbandry against 40.4% on modern technology for crop farming. In India, the livestock extension services all over the country are provided mainly through the State Departments of Animal Husbandry (SDAH), apart from their major role of providing health care services. Recent advances in Information Technology (IT) are making it more feasible to disseminate livestock information among livestock owners. However, livestock owners are still lagging behind in getting timely information due to several reasons. The major cause for this is, the lack of formal education and training in IT among livestock owners. To overcome such scenario, the potential of internet and mobile networks can be explored to provide relevant information services which are (i) affordable, (ii) relevant (timely and customized), (iii) searchable and (iv)up-to-date. The mobile based technology can provide the information electronically to livestock owners anytime/anywhere at low cost. To harness the potential of IT, IVRI-Pashu Prajanan (Animal Reproduction) App has been developed in collaboration with ICAR-IVRI, Izatnagar for dissemination of the information related to livestock. This is an educational mobile app for graduating veterinarians, field veterinary officers and livestock entrepreneurs, providing information about major reproductive diseases/ disorders in cattle and buffaloes and measures to treat and control them. Twelve (12) major reproductive diseases/disorders are covered in the App. All the information of reproductive problems/disorders is provided under the major heads viz. What and How, Symptoms, Treatment and Prevention. The App additionally provides basic information on heat detection and artificial insemination in cattle and buffaloes. Presently, the App provides information in 8 languages viz. Hindi, English, Punjabi, Bengali, Assamese, Gujarati, Tamil and Malayalam. The app is developed in Android platform and is freely available on Google Play store.

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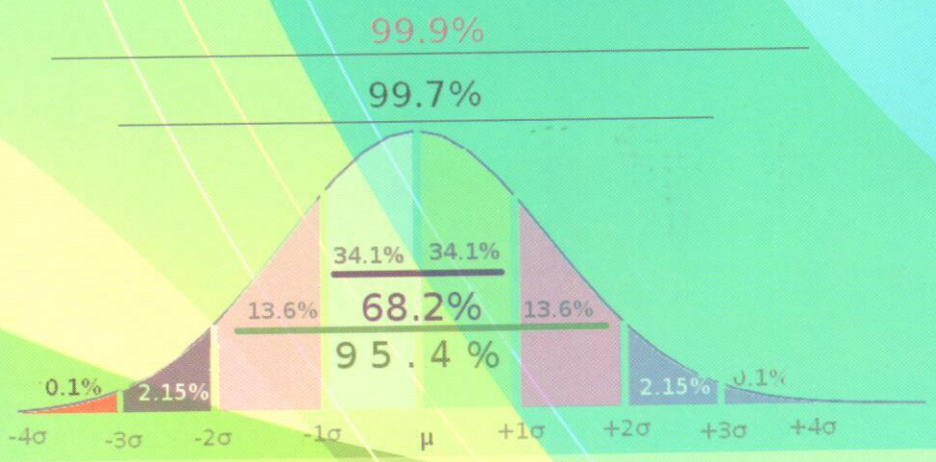
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